TEACHER ONLY

Build the Lineup: Answer Key

Market Segmentation Project

PROJECT AT A GLANCE

Where it fits	Third step in the marketing sequence. Target Marketing found the customer, Million Dollar Media Buy spent money on given segments, and this project has students define segments themselves and design a product and price for each one.
Groups	Pairs. 12 case files. With more than 12 pairs, give two pairs the same company and compare their lineups during presentations.
Timing	Block 1: launch deck (about 25 minutes), warm-up, segment names, feature sort. Block 2: build versions, price tests, one-version comparison, slides. Block 3 (optional): presentations.
Student files	One case file per pair, the Student Guide (one per student), and the slide template.

HOW THE SCORING WORKS

- Unit cost = base cost + every feature added.
- Fit starts at 100%, rises 5% for each nice-to-have (30 to 59%) included, then halves for each must-have (60% or more) left out.
- Buyers = segment size × % who would buy at that price × Fit, rounded to a whole number.
- Profit = buyers × (price − unit cost).

GRADING GUIDANCE

- The “most profitable” builds in this key are maximums found by checking every possible combination. Do not expect students to match them.
- Full credit on feature choices: every must-have included and nothing the segment rated under 30%. Nice-to-haves are a judgment call either way.
- Full credit on pricing: at least two prices tested per version and the more profitable one chosen.
- A lineup within about 80% of the key's total is excellent work.
- Check that the one-version comparison in Step 6 comes out lower than their lineup. If it doesn't, their versions probably include features a segment doesn't want.

THINK IT THROUGH: LOOK-FORS

1. Most profitable version: Rarely the highest price. Strong answers point to segment size and % who would buy, not just price per unit.

2. Price-sensitive segment: The line with the steepest drop on the price chart. Strong answers say to keep that version lean so its price can stay low.

3. Cannibalization: Premium customers would trade down if the cheap version had their must-haves. Good lineups keep each segment's must-haves out of the cheaper versions (fences).

CASE FILE 01

Driftwave Audio

wireless earbuds | base cost $14 per pair

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Gym Grinders B: Everyday Students C: Work-From-Anywhere Pros

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment C, with 3 must-haves.
2. Active noise cancellation at $18. Must-have for Segment C.
3. $49 (41% would buy).
4. 9,000 × 37% = 3,330 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Gym Grinders	Sweatproof and waterproof, Secure ear wings	$20	$79	37%	100%	3,330	$196,470
B: Everyday Students	10-hour battery	$19	$49	41%	100%	5,740	$172,200
C: Work-From-Anywhere Pros	10-hour battery, Active noise cancellation, Premium audio drivers, Clear-call microphones	$57	$159	55%	105%	2,310	$235,620
Lineup total							**$604,290**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Sweatproof and waterproof, Secure ear wings, 10-hour battery at $49 (unit cost $25): $319,272 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$604,290 total profit, about 89% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Gym Grinders	$27,324	$196,470	$169,146
B: Everyday Students	$8,064	$172,200	$164,136
C: Work-From-Anywhere Pros	$208,120	$235,620	$27,500

CASE FILE 02

Rally Paddle Co.

pickleball paddles | base cost $12 per paddle

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Park District Newbies B: Tournament Grinders C: Courtside Crew

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment A and Segment B, with 3 must-haves.
2. Carbon fiber spin face at $16. Must-have for Segment B.
3. $180 (27% would buy).
4. 11,000 × 50% = 5,500 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Park District Newbies	Wider sweet spot, Cushioned grip, Starter bundle (2 paddles + balls)	$29	$40	50%	100%	5,500	$60,500
B: Tournament Grinders	Carbon fiber spin face, Pro-weight 16mm core, Cushioned grip, Official tournament approval, Padded paddle cover	$48	$130	59%	110%	2,272	$186,304
C: Courtside Crew	Custom graphic designs	$16	$60	49%	100%	3,430	$150,920
Lineup total							**$397,724**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Carbon fiber spin face, Pro-weight 16mm core, Cushioned grip, Official tournament approval, Padded paddle cover at $130 (unit cost $48): $192,618 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$397,724 total profit, about 106% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Park District Newbies	$5,313	$60,500	$55,187
B: Tournament Grinders	$149,625	$186,304	$36,679
C: Courtside Crew	$28,980	$150,920	$121,940

CASE FILE 03

Northbound Packs

backpacks | base cost $11 per bag

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Hallway Haulers B: Carry-On Crew C: Metra Professionals

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment B, with 4 must-haves.
2. Premium leather trim at $15. Must-have for Segment C.
3. $120 (39% would buy).
4. 15,000 × 63% = 9,450 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Hallway Haulers	Padded laptop sleeve, Lifetime warranty, Side water bottle pockets	$24	$45	63%	100%	9,450	$198,450
B: Carry-On Crew	Padded laptop sleeve, Suitcase-style clamshell opening, Water-resistant fabric, Hidden anti-theft pocket, Side water bottle pockets	$30	$90	65%	105%	4,095	$245,700
C: Metra Professionals	Padded laptop sleeve, Water-resistant fabric, Hidden anti-theft pocket, Premium leather trim	$38	$120	61%	105%	3,202	$262,564
Lineup total							**$706,714**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Padded laptop sleeve, Suitcase-style clamshell opening, Water-resistant fabric, Hidden anti-theft pocket, Premium leather trim, Side water bottle pockets at $120 (unit cost $45): $430,350 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$706,714 total profit, about 64% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Hallway Haulers	$34,650	$198,450	$163,800
B: Carry-On Crew	$147,420	$245,700	$98,280
C: Metra Professionals	$210,420	$262,564	$52,144

CASE FILE 04

Frame Fitness

workout app memberships | base cost $1 per member per month

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Fresh Starters B: Sport Trainers C: Home Gym Crowd

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment B and Segment C, with 3 must-haves.
2. 1-on-1 coach messaging at $6. No segment lists it as a must-have.
3. $20 (25% would buy).
4. 20,000 × 60% = 12,000 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Fresh Starters	Guided video workouts	$2	$6	60%	100%	12,000	$48,000
B: Sport Trainers	Performance stats and tracking, Sport-specific training plans, Smartwatch sync	$5	$15	52%	100%	3,120	$31,200
C: Home Gym Crowd	Guided video workouts, Live instructor classes, Smartwatch sync, Equipment workout library, Community challenges	$8	$20	64%	110%	3,520	$42,240
Lineup total							**$121,440**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Guided video workouts, Smartwatch sync, Equipment workout library at $10 (unit cost $3.50): $55,308.50 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$121,440 total profit, about 120% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Fresh Starters	$550	$48,000	$47,450
B: Sport Trainers	$4,500	$31,200	$26,700
C: Home Gym Crowd	$20,125	$42,240	$22,115

CASE FILE 05

Polar Pop Cameras

instant cameras | base cost $22 per camera

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Party Snappers B: Event Pros C: Creative Hobbyists

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment B and Segment C, with 3 must-haves.
2. Glass lens upgrade at $15. Must-have for Segment C.
3. $200 (19% would buy).
4. 12,000 × 63% = 7,560 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Party Snappers	Fun color shells, Selfie mirror	$26	$60	63%	100%	7,560	$257,040
B: Event Pros	Print-from-phone app, Rechargeable battery, Rugged drop-proof body	$46	$150	54%	100%	1,350	$140,400
C: Creative Hobbyists	Manual exposure controls, Creative modes, Glass lens upgrade	$54	$110	62%	100%	2,480	$138,880
Lineup total							**$536,320**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Fun color shells, Selfie mirror at $60 (unit cost $26): $281,486 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$536,320 total profit, about 91% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Party Snappers	$27,048	$257,040	$229,992
B: Event Pros	$96,424	$140,400	$43,976
C: Creative Hobbyists	$103,224	$138,880	$35,656

CASE FILE 06

Grip Gaming

game controllers | base cost $15 per controller

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Couch Co-op Crowd B: Ranked Grinders C: Parent Buyers

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment B and Segment C, with 3 must-haves.
2. Drift-proof magnetic sticks at $10. Must-have for Segment B and Segment C.
3. $180 (19% would buy).
4. 16,000 × 52% = 8,320 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Couch Co-op Crowd	40-hour rechargeable battery	$21	$45	52%	100%	8,320	$199,680
B: Ranked Grinders	Back paddles, Drift-proof magnetic sticks, Trigger stops, Swappable faceplates	$41	$130	54%	105%	2,835	$252,315
C: Parent Buyers	Drift-proof magnetic sticks, Reinforced drop-proof shell, 2-year replacement warranty	$37	$65	23%	100%	1,840	$51,520
Lineup total							**$503,515**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Back paddles, Drift-proof magnetic sticks, Trigger stops, Swappable faceplates at $130 (unit cost $41): $252,315 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$503,515 total profit, about 100% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Couch Co-op Crowd	$15,456	$199,680	$184,224
B: Ranked Grinders	$211,140	$252,315	$41,175
C: Parent Buyers	$9,408	$51,520	$42,112

CASE FILE 07

Shellshock Cases

phone cases | base cost $3 per case

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Style Swappers B: Butterfingers C: Job Site Tough

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment C, with 4 must-haves.
2. Waterproof seal at $8. Must-have for Segment C.
3. $45 (29% would buy).
4. 18,000 × 62% = 11,160 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Style Swappers	Trendy prints and colors	$4	$20	62%	100%	11,160	$178,560
B: Butterfingers	10-foot drop rating, Raised lip + screen protector	$9	$30	65%	100%	7,800	$163,800
C: Job Site Tough	10-foot drop rating, Raised lip + screen protector, Waterproof seal, Belt clip holster	$20	$60	46%	100%	1,840	$73,600
Lineup total							**$415,960**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Trendy prints and colors, 10-foot drop rating, Raised lip + screen protector at $30 (unit cost $10): $288,200 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$415,960 total profit, about 44% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Style Swappers	$21,735	$178,560	$156,825
B: Butterfingers	$77,256	$163,800	$86,544
C: Job Site Tough	$64,722	$73,600	$8,878

CASE FILE 08

Pass Lane Driving School

driver's training packages | base cost $120 per student

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Permit Parents B: Late Starters C: Test-Day Only

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment A and Segment B, with 3 must-haves.
2. Extra 4 hours behind the wheel at $110. Must-have for Segment B.
3. $600 (36% would buy).
4. 6,000 × 63% = 3,780 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Permit Parents	Online classroom course, Pickup at home or school, Parent progress app	$185	$375	63%	100%	3,780	$718,200
B: Late Starters	Extra 4 hours behind the wheel, Expressway lesson, Weekend scheduling	$290	$475	66%	100%	990	$183,150
C: Test-Day Only	Road test car + scheduling	$160	$300	46%	100%	1,610	$225,400
Lineup total							**$1,126,750**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Online classroom course, Pickup at home or school, Parent progress app at $375 (unit cost $185): $808,070 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$1,126,750 total profit, about 39% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Permit Parents	$144,000	$718,200	$574,200
B: Late Starters	$114,885	$183,150	$68,265
C: Test-Day Only	$6,960	$225,400	$218,440

CASE FILE 09

Marquee Cinemas

monthly movie passes | base cost $6 per member per month

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Friday Night Regulars B: Family Outing C: Big Screen Buffs

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment B, with 4 must-haves.
2. No monthly cap at $6. Must-have for Segment C.
3. $22 (46% would buy).
4. 15,000 × 27% = 4,050 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Friday Night Regulars	Free popcorn refills, Snack combo discounts	$8.50	$16	27%	100%	4,050	$30,375
B: Family Outing	Bring-a-guest pass, Free popcorn refills, Snack combo discounts, Kids' matinee club	$13.50	$22	46%	100%	4,140	$35,190
C: Big Screen Buffs	Premium formats, Early screenings, No monthly cap	$20	$28	57%	100%	1,710	$13,680
Lineup total							**$79,245**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Free popcorn refills, Snack combo discounts, Kids' matinee club at $16 (unit cost $9.50): $49,270 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$79,245 total profit, about 61% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Friday Night Regulars	$0	$30,375	$30,375
B: Family Outing	$3,366	$35,190	$31,824
C: Big Screen Buffs	$6,171	$13,680	$7,509

CASE FILE 10

Shine Club Car Wash

car wash memberships | base cost $5 per member per month

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: First-Car Proud B: Gig Drivers C: Minivan Families

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment B, with 4 must-haves.
2. Interior wipe-down by staff at $8. Must-have for Segment B.
3. $40 (40% would buy).
4. 7,000 × 57% = 3,990 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: First-Car Proud	Free vacuums, Tire shine and wax, Free air freshener	$9.50	$15	57%	100%	3,990	$21,945
B: Gig Drivers	Unlimited washes, Free vacuums, Interior wipe-down by staff, 24-hour access, Free air freshener	$22.50	$40	40%	105%	1,260	$22,050
C: Minivan Families	Free vacuums, Underbody salt rinse, Family multi-car plan	$13	$22	61%	100%	5,490	$49,410
Lineup total							**$93,405**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Free vacuums, Underbody salt rinse, Family multi-car plan, Free air freshener at $22 (unit cost $13.50): $55,454 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$93,405 total profit, about 68% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: First-Car Proud	$0	$21,945	$21,945
B: Gig Drivers	$10,350	$22,050	$11,700
C: Minivan Families	$5,940	$49,410	$43,470

CASE FILE 11

Stride Watch

smartwatches | base cost $30 per watch

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Mile Chasers B: First-Watch Teens C: Safety-First Seniors

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment A and Segment C, with 3 must-haves.
2. Cellular connection at $25. No segment lists it as a must-have.
3. $90 (41% would buy).
4. 6,000 × 52% = 3,120 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Mile Chasers	Built-in GPS, Text and call alerts, Heart-rate sensors, 2-week battery	$64	$180	52%	105%	3,276	$380,016
B: First-Watch Teens	Text and call alerts, Swappable bands and faces	$37	$90	41%	100%	4,920	$260,760
C: Safety-First Seniors	Text and call alerts, Fall detection + emergency SOS, Heart-rate sensors	$53	$130	61%	100%	3,050	$234,850
Lineup total							**$875,626**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	Built-in GPS, Text and call alerts, Fall detection + emergency SOS, Heart-rate sensors, 2-week battery at $180 (unit cost $73): $504,398 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$875,626 total profit, about 74% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Mile Chasers	$250,536	$380,016	$129,480
B: First-Watch Teens	$27,324	$260,760	$233,436
C: Safety-First Seniors	$104,974	$234,850	$129,876

CASE FILE 12

Bounce Zone Trampoline Park

visit passes | base cost $4 per visit

SUGGESTED SEGMENT NAMES

A: Friday Night Crew B: Toddler Time Parents C: Ninja Course Athletes

Any name that matches the profile earns credit.

WARM-UP ANSWERS

1. Segment B, with 3 must-haves.
2. Coach-led fitness class at $6. Must-have for Segment C.
3. $28 (21% would buy).
4. 14,000 × 40% = 5,600 buyers.

MOST PROFITABLE VERSION FOR EACH SEGMENT

Segment	Features	Unit cost	Price	% buy	Fit	Buyers	Profit
A: Friday Night Crew	2-hour jump time, Glow night DJ and lights	$9	$20	40%	100%	5,600	$61,600
B: Toddler Time Parents	Toddler-only hours, Grip socks included, Parent lounge	$10	$20	55%	100%	3,300	$33,000
C: Ninja Course Athletes	Ninja obstacle course, Coach-led fitness class	$14	$28	59%	100%	1,770	$24,780
Lineup total							**$119,380**

Found by testing every combination of features and prices. Students will rarely land on these exact builds.

LINEUP VS. ONE VERSION

Best single version for everyone	2-hour jump time, Glow night DJ and lights, Grip socks included at $20 (unit cost $10): $73,490 total profit
Best three-version lineup	$119,380 total profit, about 62% more than the best single version

THE TRAP: EVERY FEATURE IN EVERY VERSION

If a team loads all 8 features into a version and picks its best price, here is what each segment earns:

Segment	Loaded version profit	Best version profit	Lost by loading up
A: Friday Night Crew	$1,690.50	$61,600	$59,909.50
B: Toddler Time Parents	$2,520	$33,000	$30,480
C: Ninja Course Athletes	$9,355.50	$24,780	$15,424.50